
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Middle Age Vanheim

Arrival of Man

Progress Edition 30

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Unmodded 6.37 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Middle Age Vanheim: Arrival of Man

Vanheim one-page command brief

Middle Age Vanheim combines inexpensive human infantry, berserkers, skinshifters, flying capital troops, mounted Vanir, stealth, sailing, and a concentrated Air-Glamour-Earth-Blood mage corps. Ordinary forts supply the conventional army and the two mobile Vanir leaders. The capital alone supplies Dwarven Smiths, Vanadrotts, Fay Boars, Valkyries, and Vans, so its commander and troop queues carry several competing jobs.

The dependable magical floor is narrower than the nation summary first suggests. Vanherse provide A1 G1 H1, Vanjarls A2 G1 B1 H2, Dwarven Smiths E2 plus a guaranteed five-path random, and Vanadrotts A2 G2 B1 H2 plus a guaranteed five-path random. Fire and Death exist only through those randoms. Water, Astral, and Nature have no repeatable recruitable entry point.

Run the nation through reports rather than reputation:

- 1

record whether gold, resources, recruitment points, or capital turns are the present constraint;
- 2

separate human line troops, Einheres, Skinshifters, and capital units by job;
- 3

recruit mundane leadership where magic is unnecessary;
- 4

label every Dwarven Smith and Vanadrott by final paths;
- 5

treat the rare second random as a bonus, never as an opening promise;
- 6

track Air, Earth, Glamour, Blood, and Death spending separately;
- 7

use stealth and sailing as route options only after checking the actual order and destination;
- 8

keep a conventional reserve behind raiders and mobile groups;
- 9

test each battlefield package against the enemy's armour, morale, size, mobility, and magic;
- 10

preserve every unresolved transformation, mounted, summon, and movement claim.

Vanheim evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age Vanheim on the Book I 6.36 live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, costs, recruitment markings, visible paths, national summary, sites, and national spell tables. Nation ID 78, ordinary-fort memberships, random masks, capital-site fields, spell restrictions, item-rebate links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

This is a planning dossier, not a claim that every legal order or battle result was observed. Sailing routes, trace-income resolution, shape changes, mounted interactions, random-path presentation, summon implementation, hero timing, and battlefield performance remain outside the verified layer.

Vanheim conversion chain

Input	Conversion	Output	Control question
Gold and resources	Ordinary troop recruitment	Human line, Einheres, and Skinshifters	Is the fort limited by gold, resources, or recruitment points?
Gold and commander turns	Vanherse and Vanjarls	Air, Glamour, priesthood, Blood, leadership, stealth, and sailing options	Does this job require an expensive mage-commander?

Input	Conversion	Output	Control question
Capital commander turns	Dwarven Smiths and Vanadrotts	Earth forging, broad random access, stronger Air/Glamour/Blood, and high leadership	Which capital-only role is currently missing?
Capital troop turns	Fay Boars, Valkyries, and Vans	Supply, flying sacred pressure, or mounted Vanir	Is this worth displacing another capital recruit?
Research and gems	National and general magic	Battlefield Valkyries, Draugar, forging, buffs, summons, and counters	Is there a legal repeatable caster, not merely a theoretical path?
Scouts, stealth, and movement options	Information and pressure	Better route coverage and concealed threats	What report confirms the route, target, and fallback?
Blood access and slaves	Sacrifice or Blood magic	Dominion pressure and a wider spell economy	Are hunting, unrest, transport, and mage-turn costs funded?

The chain fails when the capital queue is asked to solve every problem, rare paths are treated as guaranteed, or mobile forces move beyond report coverage and replacement support.

Vanheim national rules that shape planning

The manual describes ocean sailing, trace income across oceans, flying troops, illusions, a Cold +1 preference, average priests who can perform blood sacrifices, and Standard Forts. It also describes a military built from heavy infantry, skinshifters, Valkyries, berserkers, and Vanir, with Air, Glamour, Earth, Blood, and some Fire and Death magic.

These are operational categories, not complete formulas. Cold preference can guide scale planning; sailing can alter route choice; flying and stealth can change threat geometry; and blood sacrifice can convert slaves into dominion pressure. None removes the need to check legal destinations, leadership, detection, income, supply, fatigue, or order resolution.

Sailing and trace-income evidence boundary

Vanherse, Vanjarls, and Vanadrotts print Army Sailing and Ship Size 5. The nation summary prints ocean sailing and trace income across oceans. Those fields establish that a special movement and economic identity exists, but this chapter does not invent capacity totals, route blockers, coast requirements, collection timing, rounding, or interaction with hostile control.

Before relying on an ocean route, record the origin, destination, commander, carried units, unit sizes, intervening provinces, ownership, and the order shown by the current interface. Before budgeting trace income, use actual treasury and province reports rather than a derived rate that the cited tables do not provide.

Vanheim capital sites and recruitment geography

Site	ID	Verified fields
The Halls of Andvare	15	E3 monthly gems; Dwarven Smith and Fay Boar recruitment records
Vanhalla	35	A1 and G1 monthly gems; Vanadrott, Van, and Valkyrie recruitment records

The capital therefore produces five gems each month: three Earth, one Air, and one Glamour. It also contains both capital commander lines and all three capital troop lines. Losing access to the capital queue is more damaging than the gem total alone suggests.

Complete Vanheim commander membership

Commander	Gold	Resources	Recruitment points	Location	Verified magic or job
Scout	35	4	1	Ordinary forts	Stealth 50, forest and mountain survival, short bow
Herse	55	22	1	Ordinary forts	Mundane leadership 75
Vanherse	235	16	2	Ordinary forts	A1 G1 H1, leadership 75, glamour, stealth, sailing, mounted
Vanjarl	440	18	2	Ordinary forts	A2 G1 B1 H2, leadership 100, glamour, stealth, sailing, mounted
Dwarven Smith	195	2	4	Capital, Halls of Andvare	E2 plus two structured random rolls, Master Smith 1
Vanadrott	595	19	4	Capital, Vanhalla	A2 G2 B1 H2 plus two structured random rolls, leadership 150, glamour, stealth, sailing, mounted

The manual and pinned memberships reconcile four ordinary-fort commanders and two capital-site commanders. The ordinary Scout is not the Early Age Van Scout, and the two capital mages must not be treated as universally recruitable.

Vanheim commander jobs

- Scout: report gathering and route confirmation without consuming a mage turn.
- Herse: conventional leadership when a force does not require priesthood, magic leadership, stealth, or sailing.
- Vanherse: cheaper mobile Air-Glamour priest and commander; useful where A1 G1 H1 is enough.
- Vanjarl: stronger Air, H2 priesthood, native B1, and higher leadership from an ordinary fort.
- Dwarven Smith: capital Earth researcher and forger whose guaranteed random determines its additional role.
- Vanadrott: expensive capital Air-Glamour-Blood leader and priest whose final randoms may open rare thresholds.

The first economy control is to avoid paying Vanjarl or Vanadrott prices for a Herse's job. The second is to avoid turning every Smith into a generic researcher when its final paths make it the only available specialist for a planned spell or item.

Complete Vanheim troop membership

Troop	Gold	Resources	Recruitment points	Location	Printed distinction
Huskarl, axe	10	12	9	Ordinary forts	Axe and javelin, Defence 11
Huskarl, spear	10	12	9	Ordinary forts	Spear and javelin, Defence 12
Hirdman, spear	12	20	14	Ordinary forts	Protection 16, spear, Defence 12

Troop	Gold	Resources	Recruitment points	Location	Printed distinction
Hirdman, broad sword	12	22	14	Ordinary forts	Protection 16, broad sword, Defence 13
Einhere	25	21	31	Ordinary forts	Two weapons, Ambidextrous 1, Berserker +5
Skinshifter	25	7	36	Ordinary forts	Great sword, forest survival, printed regeneration 10%
Fay Boar	100	1	30	Capital, Halls of Andvare	Trample, forest survival, Supply 100
Valkyrie	45	15	29	Capital, Vanhalla	Flying, glamour, sacred, stealth 65, spirit sight
Van	60	16	21	Capital, Vanhalla	Mounted, glamour, sacred, stealth 65, lance and javelin

Same-name Huskarls and Hirdmen remain separate objects. The capital-only troops come from site records and should not be counted as ordinary fort recruitment.

Vanheim troop jobs

- Axe Huskarl: cheap javelin screen whose axe gives a different contact profile from the spear variant.
- Spear Huskarl: cheap javelin screen with a spear and one additional printed Defence point.
- Spear Hirdman: protected line body with the spear's attack profile.
- Broad-sword Hirdman: slightly more resource-intensive protected line with one additional printed Defence point.
- Einhere: costly two-weapon berserker that needs a deliberate target and fatigue plan.
- Skinshifter: resource-light great-sword body with printed regeneration and an unresolved transformation chain.
- Fay Boar: capital supply carrier and trampler; its economic and combat value must be assessed separately.
- Valkyrie: flying sacred stealth unit for mobility, flanking, or concentrated attack after route and counter checks.
- Van: mounted sacred stealth unit with high Defence, lance contact, and capital-only replacement.

These labels identify candidate jobs. They do not establish expansion counts, formations, casualty rates, transformation results, or the best unit against an unknown enemy.

Vanheim capital queue doctrine

Vanheim's capital commander queue must choose between the 195-gold Dwarven Smith and the 595-gold Vanadrott. The Smith is the repeatable Earth and forging base; the Vanadrott provides stronger Air, Glamour, Blood, priesthood, leadership, sailing, and a different five-path mask. Neither is an automatic default.

The capital troop queue separately chooses among Fay Boars, Valkyries, and Vans. Fay Boars address supply and size-based contact; Valkyries address flying sacred reach; Vans provide mounted sacred reach. The correct choice depends on the active constraint, enemy, bless, route, and replacement horizon.

Reading Vanheim's random paths

Dwarven Smiths and Vanadrotts each receive one guaranteed one-level random and one independent ten-percent one-level random. Each roll selects uniformly from its own five-path mask. The rare roll can repeat the guaranteed path.

For any named path inside either mask:

- the guaranteed roll selects it on 20% of recruits;
- the rare roll adds it on 2% of all recruits;
- it appears at least once on 21.6% of recruits;
- it appears on both rolls on 0.4% of recruits.

The rare roll fires on ten percent of all recruits. It repeats the guaranteed path on two percent of all recruits and selects a different path on eight percent. These figures are arithmetic from the pinned masks, not live samples.

Dwarven Smith final-path portfolio

The Dwarven Smith begins E2. Its mask is Fire, Air, Earth, Death, or Glamour.

Final branch	Probability
F1 E2, A1 E2, E3, E2 D1, or E2 G1, each with no rare addition	18% each
F2 E2, A2 E2, E4, E2 D2, or E2 G2, each from a repeated rare path	0.4% each
Any particular mixed pair from F, A, E, D, and G	0.8% each

There are ten possible mixed pairs. Together the five ordinary branches account for 90%, the five repeated-path branches for 2%, and the ten mixed branches for 8%. Every Smith has Earth 2; additional Earth produces E3 or rarely E4, while Fire, Air, Death, and Glamour remain branch-dependent.

Vanadrott final-path portfolio

The Vanadrott begins A2 G2 B1 H2. Its mask is Air, Earth, Death, Glamour, or Blood.

Final branch	Probability
One added A, E, D, G, or B with no rare addition	18% each
The same named path added twice	0.4% each
Any particular mixed pair from A, E, D, G, and B	0.8% each

The strongest rare native endpoints are A4, E2, D2, G4, or B3 on the relevant repeated branch. Mixed outcomes can combine thresholds, including the A3 D1 result required for Summon Valkyries, but a particular mixed pair appears on only 0.8% of Vanadrotts.

Vanheim native path boundary

Path	Repeatable recruitable access	Boundary
Fire	Dwarven Smith F1 on 21.6%, rarely F2 on 0.4%	No fixed recruitable Fire.

Path	Repeatable recruitable access	Boundary
Air	Vanherse A1; Vanjarl A2; Vanadrott A2, A3 on 21.6%, rarely A4; Smith random up to A2	Broad Air access, but the highest thresholds are rare or need conversion.
Water	None	Requires Pretender, independent, summon, empowerment, or another verified bridge.
Earth	Every Smith E2; E3 on 21.6%, rarely E4; Vanadrott random up to E2	Strong Earth is capital-dependent.
Astral	None	Requires an external bridge.
Death	Smith or Vanadrott D1 on 21.6%, rarely D2	No fixed recruitable Death.
Nature	None	The manual's eastern dwarf result is a summon, not recruitable access.
Glamour	Vanherse and Vanjarl G1; Vanadrott G2, G3 on 21.6%, rarely G4; Smith random up to G2	Glamour depth is concentrated in the capital Vanadrott queue.
Blood	Vanjarl and Vanadrott B1; Vanadrott B2 on 21.6%, rarely B3	Repeatable fixed Blood exists, but depth is capital-random.
Holy	Vanherse H1; Vanjarl and Vanadrott H2	Average priesthood with blood sacrifice.

Rare maximums show what can exist, not what a schedule can assume. A plan should state its guaranteed floor, required random, expected recruitment burden, gems, boosters, and fallback.

Vanheim national spell and ritual reconciliation

Name	Type	Level	Requirement	Cost	Printed result
Summon Valkyries	Battlefield spell	Conjuration 6	A3 D1	100 fatigue	Seven Valkyries; unusable underwater
Awaken Draugar	Ritual	Conjuration 4	D2	12 Death gems	Four Draugar; unusable underwater
Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions	Ritual	Conjuration 8	A4 E3	62 Air gems	One unique directional dwarf; unusable underwater

The manual and pinned nation-restriction rows agree on these three active records. The table establishes legal thresholds, costs, counts, and the underwater prohibition. It does not establish placement, persistence, selection rules, or combat outcomes.

Vanheim national-magic access ladder

Spell or ritual	Unassisted repeatable access
Summon Valkyries	A Vanadrott must receive both Air and Death across its two rolls: 0.8% of Vanadrotts. Vanlade also qualifies, but is a hero and not repeatable.
Awaken Draugar	A Dwarven Smith or Vanadrott must receive Death on both rolls: 0.4% of either line. Vanlade qualifies but is not schedulable.
Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions	No unassisted repeatable recruit naturally combines A4 and E3. Path conversion, empowerment, a summon, or Pretender support is required.

Researching a national spell does not create its caster. Vanheim should audit the mage roster before committing to a national-magic branch and keep a general-spell fallback when the required rare recruit has not appeared.

Four Directions ritual boundary

The manual's Middle Age table prints Dwarf of the East, with A4 E3 N2 and Master Smith 2. The pinned structured record links North, South, East, and West candidates through a dwarfs selection group. This establishes a four-object relationship but not a chosen direction, deterministic order, repeat-cast handling, or uniqueness implementation.

The safe plan treats Conjuration 8, A4 E3, sixty-two Air gems, a laboratory, and a free mage-turn as necessary inputs while leaving the actual directional result unresolved. No strategy chain should depend on receiving one particular dwarf unless later versioned evidence closes that question.

Vanheim national item metadata

No pinned item row restricts an item to nation 78. Six rows assign Vanheim a nation-rebate link:

Item	ID	Constructio n	Requirem ent	Native access boundary
Dwarven Hammer	29	3	E3	A Smith reaches E3 on 21.6%; rarely E4.
Lightweight Scale Mail	236	3	A1	Vanherse, Vanjarl, and Vanadrott qualify.
Weightless Scale Mail	262	7	A1	Vanherse, Vanjarl, and Vanadrott qualify.
Pebble Skin Suit	280	9	B4 E1	No unassisted repeatable recruit reaches B4.
Cauldron of the Elven Halls	361	5	G3	A Vanadrott reaches G3 on 21.6%; rarely G4.
Draupnir	435	9	E5	No unassisted repeatable recruit reaches E5.

A rebate link is not a restriction and does not itself grant the required path. The chapter does not infer the current displayed price, rounding, stacking, or immediate forgeability from the metadata field alone.

Vanheim hero records

Fixed name	Unit identity	Verified magic	Boundary
Farbaute	Einhere	none	Hero assignment only
Vanlade	Vanadrott	A3 D2 G2 B2 H2	Raw late-hero value 10; timing semantics unresolved

Vanlade qualifies for Summon Valkyries and Awaken Draugar and widens several other thresholds. That makes the hero useful when present, not a repeatable research or ritual bridge. Farbaute's performance and both arrival conditions remain outside the source-backed schedule.

Vanheim patch reconciliation

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026. The retained official ledger contains one 6.13 presentation record naming Vanheim and Helheim, published 15 May 2024, but no directly named mechanical correction for Vanadrott, Vanjarl, Dwarven Smith, Vanhalla, the Halls of Andvare, Awaken Draugar, or Summon Valkyries through 6.36.

The presentation record is not converted into a gameplay change. The revision-2 manual controls current player-facing descriptions, while the 6.35 structured export remains labelled as a pinned cross-check.

Vanheim opening priorities

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns limit each fort.
- 2 Use Huskarls for cheap coverage and Hirdmen where protection is worth the resource cost.
- 3 Recruit mundane Herse leadership when a mage-commander adds no necessary capability.
- 4 Decide whether the next capital commander solves Earth/forging or Air/Glamour/Blood/leadership.
- 5 Label every Smith and Vanadrott immediately, including whether the rare roll appeared.
- 6 Keep Fire, Death, high Earth, high Glamour, and high Air plans conditional on the actual roster.
- 7 Add scouts before sailing, stealth, or flying forces outrun reliable province reports.
- 8 Track capital troop replacement separately from ordinary infantry replacement.
- 9 Match research to legal casters and the gem treasury rather than to national spell names alone.
- 10 Maintain a reserve that can answer raiders without recalling every forward mobile group.

These are planning controls. Exact expansion parties, routes, formations, scripts, blesses, and casualty expectations remain open.

Vanheim recruitment packages to compare

Cheap javelin screen

Both Huskarls cost ten gold and carry javelins. The spear variant has one more printed Defence; the axe variant changes the contact attack. They provide affordable bodies and opening missile pressure, but Morale 10, Protection 11, and ordinary human statistics make leadership and the enemy attack profile important.

Protected Hirdman line

Both Hirdmen provide Protection 16 and Morale 11. The spear costs twenty resources; the broad-sword variant costs twenty-two and has one more printed Defence. This line converts resources into staying power, so it should be compared with the number of Huskarls, Skinshifters, or commanders the same fort could produce.

Einhere striking group

Einheres combine two weapons, Ambidextrous 1, Berserker +5, Morale 13, and Protection 16. At twenty-five gold, twenty-one resources, and thirty-one recruitment points, they are not disposable line filler. Formation width, fatigue, target Defence, armour, and berserk consequences determine whether their extra attacks convert into value.

Skinshifter group

Skinshifters cost twenty-five gold but only seven resources and print a great sword, forest survival, and regeneration. Their thirty-six recruitment points can become the limiting cost. The chapter does not assume how their shape chain, wounds, equipment, regeneration, or post-battle state resolve.

Capital flying reserve

Valkyries combine flight, sacred status, glamour, stealth, spirit sight, and a light lance. They can threaten exposed units or distant points, but forty-five gold and twenty-nine recruitment points compete with every other capital troop. Flight does not remove the need for priest support, route confirmation, formation, or a counter plan.

Capital mounted reserve

Vans combine high Defence, sacred status, glamour, stealth, a lance, a javelin, and a Fay Horse. Their sixty-gold cost and capital-only replacement make unsupported trades expensive. Mounted damage, rider-mount interaction, and remounting remain unresolved.

Vanheim research response tree

Branch A: ordinary Air and Glamour support

Vanherse and Vanjarls provide repeatable A1-A2 and G1 from every fort, while Vanadrotts provide A2 G2. Early research can therefore favour general spells these guaranteed paths can cast. The exact branch still depends on enemy armour, mobility, resistance, battlefield size, and the gems available.

Branch B: Construction and the Smith economy

Every Dwarven Smith has E2 and Master Smith 1. Construction turns that guaranteed floor and the Smith's random into general equipment, while the six rebate links create additional candidates. A forge schedule must still record the final path, current price, required gems, research, laboratory, and lost research or ritual turn.

Branch C: Conjunction 4 and Draugar

Awaken Draugar requires D2, which only a same-path double random supplies naturally on a Smith or Vanadrott at 0.4% per recruit. Conjunction 4 should therefore be justified by the general spell list as well as a ritual that may lack a caster. If D2 appears, twelve Death gems and a mage-turn produce the printed four Draugar.

Branch D: Conjunction 6 and battlefield Valkyries

Summon Valkyries requires A3 D1. A Vanadrott obtains the necessary mixed Air-Death pair on 0.8% of recruits, while Vanlade qualifies if the hero arrives. Research, the legal caster, Air-gem availability for the 100-fatigue spell, battlefield placement, and the underwater prohibition all belong in the pre-battle check.

Branch E: Conjunction 8 and the Four Directions project

The national ritual needs A4 E3 and sixty-two Air gems. No unassisted repeatable recruit supplies both paths together, so the project begins with a path-conversion design rather than with research alone. The directional result is also unresolved. This is a late infrastructure project, not a default national milestone.

Branch F: Blood and dominion pressure

Vanjarl and Vanadrott provide fixed B1, with Vanadrotts occasionally reaching B2 or rarely B3. That makes a repeatable Blood entry possible, but not free. Hunting, unrest, laboratory coverage, slave movement, sacrifice, research, and the cost of diverting expensive commanders must all be included.

Vanheim battlefield packages

Human line with separate command

Huskarls or Hirdmen hold frontage under a Herse while mages remain in protected positions. This preserves expensive Vanir turns for magic or specialist leadership. The package must be adjusted for morale, missiles, armour, fatigue, and enemy breakthrough speed.

Berserker and Skinshifter strike group

Einheres provide multiple berserk attacks while Skinshifters add great swords and a different resource profile. A human screen can absorb initial contact. The package fails when fatigue, poor target choice, congestion, missile damage, or unresolved transformation behaviour overwhelms its contact damage.

Mounted Vanir wing

Vans or mounted commander-led elements can create a mobile contact group. High Defence, glamour, stealth, lances, and javelins suggest pressure rather than invulnerability. Anti-large attacks, accurate weapons, fatigue, formation, and mounted resolution must be checked.

Valkyrie flying group

Valkyries can concentrate flying sacred bodies against a selected part of the field. Their low count, capital replacement, protection, morale, and landing target matter. A flying order without guards, priest support, report coverage, and a fallback can expose the most expensive troop line.

Sailing pressure group

Vanherse, Vanjarls, or Vanadrotts can anchor an army-sailing force if the carried group and route are legal. The package can alter strategic geometry, but exact capacity and route resolution are not supplied here. Verify the current order interface and keep a conventional land route or reserve.

Rare-path mage group

Labelled Smiths and Vanadrotts can combine Fire, Air, Earth, Death, Glamour, and Blood tools that the fixed roster cannot. Build the script from the mages actually present. Do not design a standard army around a 0.4% or 0.8% branch and then substitute an unqualified caster.

Vanheim information and pressure network

Scouts provide cheap report coverage, while Vanir commanders and several capital troops print stealth. Flying Valkyries and sailing commanders can threaten routes that ordinary armies cannot. These capabilities widen the set of possible orders but do not reveal enemy orders or guarantee concealment.

A safe pressure network layers scouts, province reports, labelled commanders, protected laboratories, gem and slave transport, fallback provinces, and a reserve. Trace-income and blood-sacrifice plans should be reconciled against actual treasury and dominion reports rather than folded into an assumed passive advantage.

Vanheim Pretender families

Family	What it can solve	What it must not conceal
Water, Astral, or Nature bridge	Adds paths absent from repeatable recruitment	A Pretender path does not create researchers, gems, or safe availability.
Four Directions enabler	Helps assemble A4 E3 for the national ritual	Sixty-two Air gems, research, mage-turns, and unresolved direction selection remain.
Blood acceleration	Adds hunting or higher Blood thresholds	Hunters, slaves, unrest control, laboratories, and opportunity cost still matter.
Economy and scales	Funds expensive Vanir, capital mages, forts, and laboratories	Gold does not create capital turns, resources, recruitment points, or rare randoms.
Sacred bless	Improves Valkyries and Vans	Both lines are capital-only and compete with other capital production.
Awake expansion body	Reduces pressure on ordinary human troops	Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, bless, script, and opponents.

No exact design is endorsed without the game settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and a versioned performance record.

Vanheim matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Massed light units	Javelins, protected frontage, multiple Einhere attacks, available area effects, and controlled flanks	Paying only for elite capital units when cheap bodies are the constraint.
Heavy armour	Great swords, axes, buffs, fatigue plans, Earth magic, and suitable rare-path spells	Assuming ordinary spears and javelins solve protection unaided.
Accurate missiles	Hirdman protection, screens, speed, stealth approaches, and target disruption	Exposing lightly protected Skinshifters, mages, or landing Valkyries.
High-Defence elites	Multiple attacks, buffs, fatigue, morale pressure, and magic that avoids Defence	Relying on one expensive lance contact.
Large or trample-resistant targets	Protected lines, Einhere attacks, Skinshifter weapons, magic, and other counters	Treating Fay Boar trample as universal damage.
Fast flankers or flyers	Guards, layered formations, reserves, and mage spacing	Leaving capital mages behind a thin human line.

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Stealth raiders	Scouts, patrol plans, forts, mobile response, and route discipline	Assuming Vanheim's own stealth automatically reveals the enemy.
Underwater pressure	Coastal defence, legal amphibious assets, allies, summons, or other verified bridges	Scheduling national spells explicitly marked unusable underwater.
Magic-resistant elites	Physical packages, buffs, fatigue, multiple attack types, and resistance-aware spells	Treating Glamour or morale tools as guaranteed control.

Monthly Vanheim audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Are both Huskarl and both Hirdman records kept distinct?
- Is the capital commander queue solving a named Smith or Vanadrott requirement?
- Is the capital troop queue producing a deliberate Fay Boar, Valkyrie, or Van?
- Is every Smith and Vanadrott labelled by final paths?
- Are 0.4% repeated and 0.8% mixed branches excluded from guaranteed schedules?
- Are mundane commanders handling jobs that do not require magic, priesthood, stealth, or sailing?
- Are Earth, Air, Glamour, Blood, and Death gems or slaves reserved against research and forging plans?
- Does every national spell have research, a legal caster, resources, a laboratory where required, and a free mage-turn?
- Are sailing, trace-income, mounted, transformation, and summon claims still kept within their evidence boundary?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must be repeatable?
- Are report coverage, fallback routes, supply, fatigue, morale, and replacement checked before battle?

Vanheim unresolved evidence boundary

The following remain open:

- 1 live 6.36 random-path display and ordering for Dwarven Smiths and Vanadrotts;
- 2 ocean-sailing capacity, route blockers, coast rules, ownership interactions, and order resolution;
- 3 trace-income collection, timing, rounding, and hostile-control interactions;
- 4 glamour, illusion, stealth, detection, and patrol outcomes;
- 5 Skinshifter shape changes, wound transfer, equipment, regeneration, and post-battle state;
- 6 rider-mount damage, fatigue, separation, death, and remounting behaviour;
- 7 Fay Boar trample, supply contribution, congestion, and target selection;
- 8 Summon Valkyries placement, persistence, scripting, targeting, and combat behaviour;
- 9 Awaken Draugar forms, equipment, leadership use, persistence, and live resolution;
- 10 Four Directions selection order, repeat casting, uniqueness, and the complete live result;
- 11 item-rebate display, price, rounding, stacking, and version-specific forge interaction;
- 12 blood hunting, sacrifice, dominion, unrest, and transport outcomes;
- 13 hero arrival timing, late-hero semantics, and live special behaviour;
- 14 expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, blessings, matchup performance, and casualty ranges;
- 15 R-047, R-058, and every comparable parked engine-dependent investigation.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. Runtime testing and preparation of new test assets remain paused.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: MA Vanheim nation page, national spells and rituals, sailing, mounts, Blood sacrifice, forging, and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.36. The retained 6.13 Vanheim and Helheim presentation record is not converted into an unnamed mechanical change.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for nation identity, ordinary-fort recruitment, random masks, capital sites, spell restrictions, item rebates, and hero records.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, printed costs, paths, site income, spell and ritual requirements, and pinned metadata are source facts. Openings, recruitment packages, research branches, force packages, Pretender families, and matchup responses are strategy. Random display, sailing and trace-income resolution, glamour and stealth outcomes, transformations, mounted behaviour, summons, item-rebate prices, Blood outcomes, hero timing, and combat results remain unresolved.